Twick o Tweat

High Concept Document

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GitHub repository: https://github.com/daggerscythe/twick-o-tweat

Engine: Unity 6 (6000.6.4f1)

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1. High Concept

1.1 High Concept Statement

Twick o Tweat is a first-person Halloween game where you hand out candy from a haunted house. Trick-or-treaters line up at your door asking for specific candy, and you have to fill their bags before they get tired of waiting, while blasting the ghosts that float in through your walls. Survive from 6 PM to 9 PM without losing all your health or letting three kids leave unhappy.

1.2 Why Would People Want to Play It?

Why would people want to play this game, and why would they pick it over another one?

- **Two games fighting each other:** filling orders is a calm counting job and shooting ghosts is a twitchy aiming job. Every ghost makes you drop what you were counting, turn around, shoot, and remember where you were.
- **Hidden power-ups to discover:** a perfect order in a bag that matches the kid's color gives a power-up. The game never tells you this up front, so finding it feels like a secret that may turn into an important strategic decision later.
- **Short and replayable:** a night is about 7 to 8 minutes, with a saved high score and a 1 to 3 pumpkin rating, so it is easy to play one more night.

2. The Player

2.1 The Player's Role

You play the new owner of the cheapest house on University Ave in Oxford, which turns out to be haunted. On Halloween night your job is to be the best candy house on the street and keep the house's ghosts off you. The verbs of the game are: **grab** a bag, **fill** it with the right candy, **count**, **deliver** it, **aim** and **shoot** ghosts, and **prioritize** which kid and which ghost to deal with first.

2.2 The Dream

This game fulfills a "dream of doing": "I wish I could be the house every kid on the block wants to trick-or-treat at" mixed with a little *Ghostbusters* fantasy of fighting off a haunted house with a homemade ghost blaster. The player should feel like a frazzled but heroic host who somehow keeps everyone happy.

2.3 Expected Player

The expected player is around 10 years old and up, comfortable with keyboard and mouse, and likes short, hectic games such as *Overcooked*, *Diner Dash*, or arcade wave shooters. An expected rating would be about E10+ for cartoon fantasy violence: the "enemies" are glowing spheres that pop when you shoot them, with no blood or gore.

Using VandenBerghe's Five Domains of Play, the expected player is someone with:

- **Medium-to-high Challenge:** they like pressure, timers, and being graded on precision, but the game stays forgiving with health regen and 3 strikes.
- **Medium Novelty:** the game mixes two familiar genres in an unusual way, and new ghost types and twists show up every phase.
- **Low Stimulation:** it is a solo game, so it fits players who like to play alone.

- **Low-to-medium Threat:** it is spooky but never actually scary, so it works for people who like Halloween but not horror.

3. Genre

Twick o Tweat is mostly a **Shooter** (3D, first-person) mixed with **Action and Arcade**. It also borrows the order-fulfillment / time-management style from games like *Overcooked*. Unlike most 3D shooters it has no ammo management: the Ecto-Blaster has infinite ammo, which is closer to the 2D shooters from the slides, because the real resource you're managing is time.

4. Primary Gameplay Mode

The primary gameplay mode is **"Serve & Defend"**: one Halloween night spent filling candy orders and shooting ghosts.

- **Camera model:** first-person and dynamic. The gun sits in the bottom right of the screen and the bag you are holding is shown in the bottom left of the HUD.
- **Interaction model:** avatar-based. You walk around the room as the homeowner and interact with what you look at, using a crosshair in the middle of the screen.
- **Challenges:** matching a candy order exactly, beating each kid's timer, protecting yourself and your bag from three kinds of ghosts, and deciding which kid and which ghost comes first when two things happen at once.
- **Actions:** move (WASD), look and aim (mouse), shoot (left click), and interact (E) with bags, candy bowls, the trash can, and kids.

5. Game Modes

Every mode, plus what moves the player between them, is described in full in Section 6 of the Game Script.

- **Tutorial (gameplay mode):** the clock is frozen at 6:00 PM, and only some actions matter. First you fill one order with no timer and no ghosts, then you fill a timed order while shooting a single weak ghost. Kids who time out here don't give strikes.
- **The Night: Serve & Defend (primary gameplay mode):** 6:00 to 9:00 PM in four phases, with every mechanic active.
- **Lights Out (Phase 4):** a variation of the primary mode where the power goes out. The actions are the same, but you can only see through a flashlight cone, and the ghosts glow.
- **Shell menus:** the intro pop-up, tutorial and phase pop-ups, the pause menu, and the results / game over screen. In all of these the game is paused and the player can't affect the game world.
- **Competition mode:** single player against the game system. There is no multiplayer. The only competition with other people or yourself is the saved high score and the pumpkin rating.

6. Game World

Twick o Tweat covers these game world dimensions:

- **Physical:** one open-plan room. The front door and porch, where up to two kids stand, are at the front. Along the back wall are a candy table with 5 bowls, a bag table with 4 colored bags, and a trash can between them. Ghosts float in through any wall.
- **Temporal:** a single Halloween night, from 6:00 PM to 9:00 PM, shown on an in-game clock that ticks in 5-minute steps.
- **Environmental:** a dim, purple-walled house with the night outside. At 8:15 PM the power goes out and the only light is your flashlight.
- **Emotional:** spooky-silly and hectic, never actually scary. The tone is closer to a Halloween cartoon than a horror game.
- **Ethical:** you only ever shoot ghosts. The gun lowers when you face the front door, so kids can never be shot, and ghosts just pop when defeated.

7. Background & Story

You just moved into the cheapest house on University Ave in Oxford, and on Halloween night you find out why it was so cheap: it is haunted. The ghosts were once kids who never got to finish trick-or-treating, and every Halloween they wake up hungry for candy. Meanwhile, word has gotten around that the new neighbor hands out the best candy on the street, and the line at your door keeps getting longer. Luckily, you found an old "Ecto-Blaster" in the attic. Your goal is to make it to 9 PM.

The candy in the game is real candy from Kazakhstan (Grilyazh, Kazakhstan, Krokant, Mishutka, and Molochno-Vafelnye).

8. Progression From Beginning to End

- **Tutorial (about 1 to 1.5 minutes):** one order with no time limit, then a timed order while shooting your first (very weak) ghost.
- **Phase 1, 6:00 to 6:45 PM:** one kid at a time and normal ghosts. You use the basics exactly as you learned them.
- **Phase 2, 6:45 to 7:30 PM:** a second kid joins the line and purple Thief Ghosts start stealing candy out of your bag.
- **Phase 3, 7:30 to 8:15 PM:** bigger orders and a Tank Ghost, which is big, slow, and hits hard.
- **Phase 4, 8:15 to 9:00 PM:** lights out. You do everything by flashlight, with the biggest orders of the night.
- **9:00 PM:** results with your score, high score, and a 1 to 3 pumpkin rating. Losing all your health or getting 3 strikes ends the night early.

Each phase lasts 90 real seconds, so the whole night takes about 6 minutes, and a full play-through with the tutorial is about 7 to 8 minutes.

9. Platform

Twick o Tweat is a single-player PC game made in Unity 6 (Universal Render Pipeline). It is built for **Windows (x86)**, **macOS**, and **Linux (x86)**, and it is played with a keyboard and mouse.